

INDUSTRIA

Study Guide



9 . 10 . 11
OCTOBER

Introduction

Industria is a 3-round crisis communications and reputation management category. Delegates are placed in the middle of a major corporate crisis and must protect the company from reputational collapse. Across three days, teams will take the crisis from the first hours of damage control, through a live press conference, to a full recovery strategy presented to the company's Board of Directors.

Every team receives the same crisis brief, meaning the competition is decided purely by strategy, communication, creativity and composure under pressure. Teams of 2-4 may participate, and no prior business background is required.

Delegate Cap: 2-4 per team in every round.

Scoring: Round 1 and Round 2 are combined for the elimination round. The combined score is then halved and carried into Round 3, making up 50% of the final score. Round 3 makes up the other 50%.

Round 1: The Crisis Breaks

Delegate Cap: 2-4

Time: 1 hour | 50 marks

All teams receive the same crisis brief simultaneously. Delegates have 5 minutes to read the brief, followed by a 50-minute creation window and 5 minutes for submission.

Teams must produce:

- Internal Crisis Response Strategy: A structured memo covering the immediate action plan, key messaging pillars, stakeholder prioritisation and risk assessment.
- Public Press Statement: An official statement written on behalf of the company for the media and public.

Both documents must be submitted digitally before the deadline. This round is non-elimination, meaning all scores carry forward. At the end of Day 1, a new development in the crisis will be revealed to all teams. This development will form part of the Day 2 challenge.

Rules:

- All teams receive the same brief at the same time.
- Internet research is permitted.
- AI assistance is strictly prohibited during the creation window.
- Both deliverables must be submitted before the deadline.
- Late submissions lose 5 marks per minute.
- A missing deliverable receives 0 marks for that criterion.
- Plagiarising or reproducing real corporate statements results in immediate disqualification.

Judging Criteria:

- Stakeholder identification and prioritisation /10
- Internal crisis strategy /10
- Public press statement /15
- Tone, professionalism and brand voice /10
- Creativity and originality /5

Round 2: The Press Conference — Elimination Round

Delegate Cap: 2-4

Preparation: 1 hour

Presentation: Up to 15 minutes per team | 50 marks (+ Round 1 carry-forward)

Following a one-hour preparation period, teams face a live press conference. Judges will act as journalists and question teams using the Day 1 crisis development.

Each team's session will include:

- Opening Statement
- Press Q&A
- Closing Statement

Questions will be based on the original crisis brief, the new development and the documents submitted during Round 1.

This is the elimination round. Round 1 and Round 2 scores are combined for a cumulative score out of 100 marks. The top 5 teams advance to Round 3.

Judging Criteria:

- Opening statement: quality and coherence /10
- Q&A: accuracy and depth of responses /15
- Incorporation of Day 1 development /10
- Composure, confidence and delivery /10
- Closing statement impact /5

Round 2: 50 marks

Round 1 + Round 2: 100 marks

Round 3: The Recovery Pitch — Final Round

Delegate Cap: 5 finalist teams of up to 4

Preparation: 2 hours

Presentation: 10 minutes per team | 50 marks (+ 50% of Rounds 1 & 2)

The crisis has settled, and the company now needs a long-term recovery strategy.

After a two-hour preparation period, finalists present a Brand Recovery Roadmap to a panel acting as the company's Board of Directors.

The presentation must cover:

- Immediate damage limitation
- Medium-term trust rebuilding
- Stakeholder communication strategy
- A realistic 6-month recovery timeline

Within the 10-minute presentation, the Board will also question delegates on:

- Financial viability
- Ethics
- Strategic decisions
- Realism of the proposed timeline
- Overall feasibility of the recovery plan

Slide decks and physical aids are permitted and encouraged, but are not mandatory.

Judging Criteria:

- Strategic depth and feasibility of recovery plan /15
- 6-month timeline and stakeholder strategy /10
- Presentation quality and delivery /10
- Innovation and creativity /10
- Board Q&A performance /5

Round 3: 50 marks